

Subject Code	ENGL5018
Subject Title	Language and Intercultural Communication in the Workplace
Credit Value	3
Level	5
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	Exclusion: ENGL568
Objectives	1. To heighten students' awareness and understanding of communication in multicultural professional organizations as it relates to the unique social, cultural, economic, and political environments in which they operate. 2. To explore the extent to which Western-based theories, methods, and practices relating to intercultural communication in organizations are applicable to Asian contexts. 3. To develop students' knowledge of and competencies in the role and use of language in intergroup communication in professional contexts. 4. To help students reflect on their experiences of intercultural communication in professional contexts in Hong Kong and elsewhere.
Intended Learning Outcomes	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: Category A: Professional/academic knowledge and skills a. Apply their understanding of key concepts and theories of intercultural communication in professional organizations through analyses of intercultural communication cases. b. Explain the extent to which Western-based theories, methods, and practices relating to intercultural communication in organizations are applicable to Asian contexts. c. Apply the readings to specific examples of intercultural communication in professional contexts, and use theories to explain the intercultural phenomena they have identified. d. Reflect on their experiences of language and intercultural communication in workplace contexts and explain how theories of intercultural communication may explain everyday interactions and cultural practices. Category B: Attributes for all-roundedness e. develop analytical reasoning, critical thinking, and problem-solving skills: ▪ <u>analytical reasoning</u>: to think in a logical manner, supporting

	ideas with sound arguments and empirical or textual evidence ▪ <u>critical thinking</u>: to evaluate information and evidence critically, be able to recognize flaws or inconsistency in an argument ▪ <u>problem solving</u>: to understand the problem, explore plausible answers, and select the most appropriate decision/solution for the problem																																														
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus	1. Defining culture and intercultural communication. 2. Approaches to and theories of intercultural communication. 3. The processes, practices, experiences, perceptions of, and barriers to communication in multicultural professional organizations. 4. Management and leadership in intercultural communication. 5. Social groups and the impact of stereotyping and prejudice on intercultural encounters. 6. Politeness in intercultural professional communication. 7. The importance of non-verbal communication in intercultural professional settings. 8. Qualities and competencies needed for effective intercultural communication in professional contexts. 9. The application of language and intercultural communication skills to specific business communication tasks.																																														
Teaching/Learning Methodology	The teaching and learning approach is task-based, student-centred, interactive, and reflective.																																														
Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes	<table><tr><th rowspan="2">Specific assessment methods/tasks</th><th rowspan="2">% weighting</th><th colspan="6">Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)</th></tr><tr><th>a</th><th>b</th><th>c</th><th>d</th><th>e</th><th></th></tr><tr><td>Mid-term assignment</td><td>40%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>Online and in-class participation</td><td>10%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>End-of-term assignment</td><td>50%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>Total</td><td>100 %</td><td colspan="6"></td></tr></table> Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes:	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)						a	b	c	d	e		Mid-term assignment	40%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓		Online and in-class participation	10%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓		End-of-term assignment	50%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓		Total	100 %						
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	The mid-term assignment is a test that will assess students' understanding and application of key course concepts. The end-of-term assignment is an analysis paper that will assess the students' ability to analyze and critically discuss an authentic case study, a discourse excerpt, or another text type from the professional workplace with appropriate references to the course literature. The participation component will assess students' proactiveness, critical awareness of the subject matter, and familiarity with the readings.	
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:	
	▪ Lecture	39 Hrs.
	▪ Seminar	0 Hrs.
	Other student study effort:	
	▪ Private study	96 Hrs.
	Total student study effort	135 Hrs.
Reading List and References	Recommended reading Baker, W. (2022). <i>Intercultural and Transcultural Awareness in Language Teaching</i>. Cambridge University Press. Holliday, A. (2013). <i>Understanding Intercultural Communication: Negotiating a Grammar of Culture</i>. London: Routledge. Jackson, J. (2014). <i>Introducing Language and Intercultural Communication</i>. London: Routledge Jackson, J. (ed.) (2020). <i>The Routledge Handbook of Language and Intercultural Communication</i> (2nd ed.). London: Routledge. Ladegaard, H.J. & Jenks, C. (eds) (2017). <i>Language and Intercultural Communication in the Workplace: Critical Approaches to Theory and Practice</i>. London: Routledge. Piller, I. (2017). <i>Intercultural communication: A critical introduction</i> (2nd ed.). Edinburgh University Press. Scollon, R., Scollon, S. W., & Jones, R. H. (2012). <i>Intercultural Communication: A Discourse Approach</i> (3rd ed.). Oxford: Wiley-Blackwell. Spencer-Oatey, H. (ed.) (2000) <i>Culturally Speaking. Managing Rapport through Talk Across Cultures</i>. London: Continuum. Vine, B. (ed.) (2017) <i>The Routledge Handbook of Language in the Workplace</i>. London: Routledge.	

	Zhu H. (ed.) (2011) <i>The Language and Intercultural Communication Reader</i>. London: Routledge Zhu, H. (2019). <i>Exploring intercultural communication: Language in action</i> (2nd edition). Routledge.
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Revised by Jenifer Ho (March 2026)